Football Blind Draft — Design Justification

MTM4681 Mobile Programming · Milestone 1 · Design language (K1): Kadir Burak Semerci

1. Concept: a matchday poster

Football Blind Draft is a 1v1 auction game: twelve fictional player cards are revealed one by one and both players bid without knowing what comes next. We deliberately avoided the default "dark mode with neon" look of mobile games and borrowed the visual language of printed football culture instead: matchday programmes, tickets and risograph posters. The metaphor carries the interaction too: the home screen's PLAY button is a ticket whose stub tears off when tapped, player cards look like printed collectibles, and the match is narrated like a newspaper live ticker.

2. Colour palette

The interface uses three "inks": **paper #F3ECD9** (background), **ink navy #14293A** (text, primary surfaces, your team) and **signal red #B92D23** (the main action, urgency and the opponent). A small palette keeps every screen calm, so the few red elements (the countdown, the PLAY ticket, the +1 bid) immediately read as "act now". Card tiers add gold #D9A421, silver #A3AEB6 and bronze #B4703F. All colours are Figma variables with semantic names (e.g. *color/bg/accent*), so the same tokens can be mapped one-to-one to a Flutter ThemeData.

Teams personalise a crest (5 shapes × 4 patterns × 10 two-colour kits × 8 icons). During a match the UI still shows **you in ink and the opponent in red**, whatever kits the teams wear, so two red teams can never be confused; the crest carries identity. Unsigned players in the draft pool wear a neutral grey shirt and switch to the club's kit once signed.

3. Typography

Anton (display) gives condensed, poster-style numerals that stay readable at a glance under time pressure: the bid timer (112 px) and player ratings (72 px). **Inter** is used for body text and buttons because it stays legible at small sizes on both iOS and Android. **IBM Plex Mono**, in small capitals, labels data like a printed ticket ("CARD 5 / 12", "5 SECOND WINDOW"). Ten text styles cover the whole app; the smallest is 11 px.



Foundations page of the FBD · Design System library: semantic colours and type ramp.



Team kits and crests: identity comes from the crest, not from in-match UI colours.

4. Layout

Every screen has **one dominant element**: the PLAY ticket on Home, the countdown on Draft, the pitch on Plan and the scoreboard on Match. Information sits at the top and **actions sit in the thumb zone** at the bottom: the PLAY ticket's centre is at about 67 % of the screen height, and the bid buttons and "Ready" button are the last element above the home indicator, so the game can be played one-handed. Outside a match a four-tab bottom bar (Play · Club · Matches · Rules) keeps the Play tab focused on playing; during a match there is no tab bar and leaving requires the explicit close button, so a match cannot be abandoned by accident. Corners are square and separators are printed rules instead of shadows.

5. Accessibility

Pair	Contrast	WCAG
Ink on paper (body text)	12.6 : 1	AA / AAA
Secondary text on paper	5.8 : 1	AA
Red on paper / paper on red	5.1 : 1	AA
Ink on gold or silver tier	6.6 : 1	AA
Ink on bronze tier	3.8 : 1	large text only

Contrast was measured with the WCAG 2.1 formula. Colour is never the only cue: your team is a filled block and the opponent an outlined one, an off-position player has a red frame *and* a "–3" penalty label, and missed penalties are dashed with an ✕. Tap targets are at least 48 px (bid buttons are 56 px tall), the minimum text size is 11 px, and the only animation in the core flow (the ticket tear, 0.45 s) does not block input.

6. Users and platforms

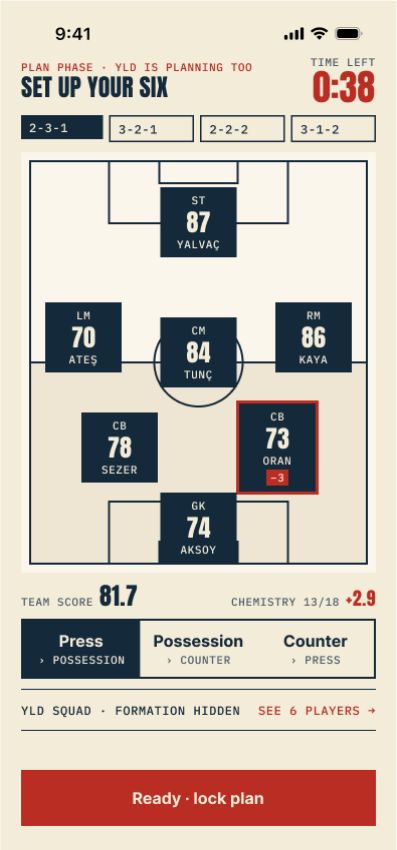
Our target users are football fans aged roughly 16–30 who want short, competitive sessions (one match takes about 5–8 minutes) on their phone, often one-handed. The app is built with Flutter for iOS and Android: the game interface is platform-neutral by design (like most games), while system elements follow each platform (iOS status bar and sheets on iPhone, Material components and back gesture on Android). All players and clubs are fictional, so the design needs no licensed names, photos or logos.



Home (Play tab): ticket in the thumb zone.



Draft: the countdown dominates; bids at the bottom.



Plan: pitch, off-position penalty, tactic.

Figma: design system https://www.figma.com/design/bgRDmCYy631F1EfBLtXsdc · screens https://www.figma.com/design/UUI6I7TsTDcTG6pM34elUJ · Prepared with AI assistance (Claude), see README.